

ELCOMA, Indian lighting industry is worth Rs 50 billion with a growth of 18-19 per cent in the previous year. CFLs were the fastest growing segment, growing at an estimated 25-28 per cent every year. India consumes around 200 million units of CFLs yearly while only about 150 million units are produced locally and the rest are imported. Sood emphasised the need for interacting more frequently with policy makers where government intervention is necessary, helping each other in absorbing and initiating new ideas.

Mohan Krishnan, senior vice president, IMRB International, said, "India is a low income country, and requires a quantum growth rate to emerge as high income country. India's urbanisation is increasing and rural household income is also on the rise. By year 2014, India will be a very interesting market for many digital gadgets." Krishnan also sees significant growth opportunities in security devices, medical electronics and education.

Session 2: Made in India—Design Challenges and Innovativeness

While initiating the topic, Debashis Dutta, senior director, DIT, briefly touched upon the overview of the Indian semiconductor design sector. "India is involved in end-to-end design activities ranging from chip architecture, development, design verification and layout, all the way to design tape out. India is aligning itself with the global semiconductor market by creating high value work in VLSI & board design and embedded software," he said.

Lalit Kumar Das, head IDDC coordinate, industrial design, IIT Delhi, pointed out that culture is the core part of innovation. He put across the idea to develop an online Wiki-EFY design culture community to bring forth new innovative designs for the electronics industry.

Adding more to the basics of product design, Philip Jacob, general manager-central, development and engineering, Bharat Electronics Ltd, explained the complete cycle starting from products selection, manufacturing, marketing and profitability in a very vivid and compact way. The session was ended on a lighter note by Kunwer Sachdev, founder and MD, Su-Kam Power systems Ltd. He stressed that India can do anything she wishes to do. Narrating his success story of building Su-Kam from a scratch, Sachdev pointed out that R&D and innovation can play a major role in the growth of the electronics industry.

Session 3: The Electronics Eco-system in India—A Bird's Eye View

While giving a background of the electronics industry, Neelam Kumar, executive director, Aplab Ltd, said, "The ecosystem analogy helps electronics companies understand better a need for interaction, probe new opportunities and achieve rapid and sustainable growth. India's capability in developing competitive products of electronics industries, especially telecom, industrial electronics and computers, has

been recognised globally. Unfortunately, India lags behind in competitiveness."

She emphasised that "There is a requirement to upgrade industrial technology base to make India a hub of modern manufacturing. Enhancing efficiency and accountability requires development of holistic solutions, and we have to collectively represent and influence the government to change the taxation regime."

Subsequently, N. Chandramohan, country head-SMT, Juki India, raised another concern. Will Indian electronics manufacturing live up to the expectations? "Yes," he said, "provided the industry becomes competitive, and the government keeps an eye on the imports worth billions of dollars, and instead encourages local manufacturing."

On the other hand, Indeevar G., GM, sales and marketing, Amara Raja Electronics Ltd, was confident that India can surpass China as a hub for consumer durables. ASSOCHAM and Ernst & Young, in a joint study, have projected that India's electronics and appliances industry will reach US\$ 40 billion by 2012 with a CAGR of 11 per cent, he pointed out.

Dr Shaleen Raizada, MD & CEO, SanShadow Consultants Pvt Ltd, enlightened the gathering on the importance of intellectual property (IP) rights for an electronics organisation. She said if an organisation has a bargaining IP portfolio, is using technology which is in public domain, and has increased valuation using IP during funding, then understanding IP is very important for the company.

Session 4: How and where to get funding and finance

This session was very informative and useful for the micro, small and medium enterprises, who are looking for funds and finances to start projects related to electronics industry. Dr P. K. Dutta, scientist-E, department of science and industrial research (DSIR), introduced DSIR and Technopreneur Promotion Programme's (TePP) initiatives in promoting innovations, financial support for R&D/design engineering, scientific/technical consultancy.

While Arun Kumar Jha, director, MSME, government of India, highlighted upon the government schemes that help in investing and getting investments, Rahul Gagal, senior vice president, defence advisory services, Religare, and P. Venkatram, ICT consultant, also spoke about ways of getting funds and financing from the government and banks.

The summit was concluded by Siva Koka, senior consultant-editorial and industry interface, EFY Enterprises, who gave the vote of thanks. Later prizes were given out to some lucky winners from the audience.

The gathered electronics fraternity unanimously appreciated the timeliness and the contemporary theme of the summit and hoped that many such meaningful summits would be organised by EFY Enterprise in future. ●

The author is a senior correspondent at EFY